

Witty Machines AG
Zeughausstrasse 31
8004 Zürich
Switzerland

May 2, 2025

To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to recommend Mr. Julien Stocher, who completed a robotics software engineering internship at Witty Machines from February 1, 2025, to May 2, 2025. Witty Machines is a Swiss robotics startup specializing in case-packing robots for the food industry, and during his time with us, Julien made valuable contributions to our software team.

Scope of Work and Key Achievements

- **RFID Integration:** Julien led the integration of an RFID reader to track Reusable Packaging Units. He not only ensured data capture from the hardware sensor but also architected the software interfaces that allow our robots to register and log each packaging unit.
- **Field Deployment Operations:** He helped operate our pilot robot during a live deployment with one of our food-industry partners. He not only ensured that the robot was operating smoothly, but also learned how to troubleshoot other machines on site to increase the overall throughput. Furthermore, he carefully observed the manual packing process performed by the workers and, based on that, suggested improvements for the robot process that led to a >200% increase in packing speed.
- **Computer Vision Model for Label Inspection:** Julien trained and validated a convolutional neural network to detect printed versus mis-printed labels on egg cartons. He then integrated this model into our ROS-based control stack, enabling real-time quality inspection during packing.
- **Instance Segmentation and Localization for Packaging Units:** Julien collected and annotated data on boxes from different vendors and trained models to detect them in images and localize them. Over multiple iterations, the models were trained and were ultimately deployed in the production system.

Professional Traits and Team Fit

Julien consistently impressed us with his diligent work ethic, technical versatility, and eagerness to learn. He approached each challenge with a positive attitude, often volunteering to stay late to refine algorithms or to deepen his expertise in a particular subject.

Conclusion and Recommendation

During his internship, Julien established a solid grounding in robotics-software and proved eager to keep learning. His practical experience, collaborative spirit, and proactive attitude would benefit any early-career role in robotics or machine-learning development. I recommend him with confidence and am happy to provide further details on request.

Sincerely,



Johannes Pankert

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